More Bat Than Usual

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Explicit

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Original Clone Character(s), Original Female Character(s)

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Gratuitous Smut, Crack, Fluff, Plot What Plot/Porn Without Plot, Wings, Wing Kink, Wing Grooming, Tails, Feral Behavior, Mutation, Magic, Human/Monster Romance, Alternate Universe - Creatures & Monsters, Creature Fic, Comedy, Animal Traits, Blood and Injury, Mild Gore, Violence, Animal Instincts, Monsters, Meet-Cute, Alien Cultural Differences, Language Barrier, Cute, Cuddling & Snuggling, Heavy Petting, Outdoor Sex, Violent Sex, Dubious Ethics, Mildly Dubious Consent

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by LadyBinary

Summary

At the edge of the Whispering Woods, an Etherian wildlife researcher is investigating a recent trend of mutated fauna - likely a long-term side effect of the Great Magicsplosion that defeated Prime. One of her magical traps does contain a mutated new species... but not one of the native fauna she was expecting.

Shameless, plotless monsterf--kery with feral, winged spacebat; barely even connected to SPOP canon at this point. It's more like 'The Shape Of Water' meets 'How To Train Your Dragon' meets 'George of the Jungle' (...meets gratuitous spacebat smut).

Chapter 1

Chapter Notes

> Inspired by gift art from WrongGowther/SpacebatJello which I'll get permission to link; shamelessly stole the absolutely delicious visual of a winged spacebat all tied up and made my own feral spacebat bby for ...reasons.
>
> Steamy reasons.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The trapped spacebat - emphasis on "bat" - hisses as she approaches. Signs of struggle litter the clearing in a wingspan's reach around him; deep slashes in the forest floor, dislodged plants and earth. Though the broad body is bound in a prone position, facedown, he wrenches up his head to meet her with a wild acid-green stare.

She winces as she sees lurid bite marks and claw slashes around the glowing bonds. His slate-blue skin is streaked with traces of lucent green. The traps themselves are harmless, but she did not account for a capture hurting himself in his attempts to *escape* one. She will have to free him immediately… if she can figure out how to do so without being shredded.

"Easy there." She holds up her hands, doing her best to keep her voice low and soothing - and to not let that voice tremble. Even flat on the ground, he looks *huge.* "Eeeeasy. You… you all right?"

"HISSSSSSSS."

"...I'll take that as a no." She fishes a ration bar from her knapsack, unwraps it and holds it up. "You hungry?"

He hisses again, but much less violently this time. The winged beast stares in suspicion, eyes narrowed, ears lowered, as she re-

wraps the bar and then places it on the ground. With a careful shove, she sends the bar skittering to within his reach.

For a moment he just sniffs it cautiously, claws flexing - leaving dangerous-looking parallel gouges in the loam. The powerful limbs are largely immobilized in the trap, but he manages to drag the bar closer with an outstretched claw... then ducks his head and chomps it down in one bite, wrapper and all.

He looks back at her, ears twitching, his expression now slightly less hostile. His plumed tail swishes slowly back and forth as she creeps closer. A low, cat-like, warbling growl starts in his throat - but then trails off, as she pulls another ration bar out of her knapsack. This one she leaves unwrapped, and holds it up in front of her as she makes her slow approach.

His prone posture seems to shrink back. The great leathery wings, which had been straining against the magical ropes, now draw close to his body - bound at a rather awkward, uncomfortable-looking angle. She winces again, feeling pangs of guilt. She set the trap yesterday; he might have been like this for hours - perhaps even overnight. “Okay. I’ll get you out of there. Easy…”

She holds the ration bar just out of reach as he snaps his jaws on empty air. “- Easy, I said!”

“Ee… zee. Easy.” The feral one's voice is rough from disuse, and he sounds out the words with some difficulty around oversized fangs. Still, he seems to at least somewhat understand her own speech. Chastened, he stretches his head out more cautiously; she crouches to let him take a bite out of the unwrapped bar.

“Thaaat’s it. Good ...uhm… good bat?” She keeps her voice low and soothing. “Tastes a lot better without the wrapper, doesn’t it?”

“G...uud,” he warbles in agreement, and eats the rest somewhat more politely from her palm.

She risks edging closer then, still crouched. Her outstretched hand no longer bears food; he eyes it with suspicion, drawing back his head, making that low uneasy noise in his throat again. Still held fast to the ground by magical bindings, his bunched muscles bear the tense look of a cornered animal. She swallows, as she considers that a wrong move might cost her a few fingers. Indeed - setting him free might cost her a few *limbs.*

Well, those in her profession always have a good healer on speed dial.

"Easy… shh, it's all right…" she murmurs, in her best impression of a tranquilized hypnotist - and then, ever so gently lays her palm against his cheek.

For a split second, his eyes widen. She offers what she hopes is a soothing smile - and then, he falls perfectly still and stares, or rather *gazes* at her. The demeanor change is startlingly immediate. His eyes fall half-closed, as his ears droop downward and all signs of tension seem to melt from his body.

Cautiously, she strokes the line of his cheekbone with her thumb. “You, uh… you like this...?”

“Yh-hnn...” he whines softly, and tilts his face into her hand. Even the tucked-in wings seem to relax, unfurling slightly beneath the ropes. Perhaps caressing the face is some sort of signal, for this species; she has seen other Etherian spacebats do this, after all. But those are… well, *domesticated* isn't the right word, is it…? At the very least, most of them don't seem *quite* as likely to use those claws against her. By… admittedly, a rather narrow margin.

“Okay…” She exhales, steeling herself. “I’m going to set you loose. You… be good? Don’t *bite* me, all right?”

“Guud,” he sighs, leaning his face into her palm. “No… bite.”

Well… she can only hope that means he understands. She swallows, and with her other hand, carefully traces a glowing line of magic wrapped around his broad slate shoulders. “...Release.”

With a hiss of dissolving magic, the ropes unravel.

Instantly, the acid-green eyes open wide. The feral one gasps, digging claws into the forest floor as limbs once more respond to his own signals - drops his head, pushing himself up with stiff, shuddering muscles - and then - like heavy skiff-sails cast into the air, the great wings *snap* open.

She stumbles back in the sudden gust of wind, and only barely catches her footing. The creature breathes in deep, ragged huffs as he draws himself up on his haunches, head bowed, massive wings stretching out and back behind him - *gods,* the span must be twenty feet or more - and then, they beat down, pushing him just high enough off the ground to find purchase with his hind claws, and the air *slams* into her.

She is thrown backwards off her feet, with as much force as if tackled by his own towering frame. A moment later, her back hits the mossy ground, fully knocking what little breath she had from her lungs. She struggles to pull in a gasp as the feral one rears up to his full, *ludicrous* stature - *gods!* That species is huge enough without digittigrade legs adding an extra foot in height!

As he takes a long stride forward, she still hasn't managed to catch her breath. His tail sweeps a wide arc across the ground as he crouches to look down at her, head tilted, face unreadably blank. Then, massive clawed hands wrap around her ribs, and lift her effortlessly into the air.

Her empty lungs fail to produce the intended shriek; the noise comes out as barely a whimper. Her back meets tree bark - *not* gently - and the grip tightens around her as she makes a weak attempt to struggle, legs dangling several feet off the ground.

When she finally manages to open her eyes, his are just inches away.

She falls still, frozen in terror. Only at eye level is it noticeable that his head is larger than hers by nearly a third. Late afternoon

sunlight rims his features through long falls of white hair. The massive wings draw up to mantle around them, spreading to cast her in shadow - save for a warm diffused glow through the translucent skin. This close, she can feel the force of his breathing - deep, rough, *bestial* - as he lowers his face to the side of her throat.

"...P...please…" she gasps weakly. "Don't… hurt me…"

Warm skin brushes hers - and she feels him draw a long, deep *sniff.*

"Easy," he breathes against her throat.

She whimpers as he inhales again, rough and avid. Then, at last, he draws back his face and huffs an exhale. He blinks down at her for a moment, those eyes still utterly unreadable.

In a voice that sounds… ever so slightly *disappointed,* he adds, "...No bite."

Chapter End Notes

Smut soon, probably. But some gratuitous patching-up and wing petting first.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

> Well uhh this chapter did NOT go in the direction I was initially planning.
>
> The Whispering Woods are a dangerous place. CW for animal/arthropod violence, some arthropod gore. I've added a section delimiter in bold for those who wish to skip the graphic part, and a summary of the whole chapter in the end notes if you want to skip it entirely. Rest assured, next chapter will be utterly fluffy.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

When at last the creature places her back on the ground, he does so with apparent reluctance. She stumbles, heart pounding, putting a hand on the tree to regain her unsteady footing. Those glowing, expressionless eyes blink down at her from… far, *far* too high above.

Staring up at him, she lifts her hands and takes a careful step back. Then another. He doesn't move. Only his eyes follow her as she slowly, carefully edges backward, out of the clearing. The blank stare does not break - holding that gaze until the brush closes between them.

Once she is sure she is out of sight, she turns on her heel and *runs.*

She approaches the edge of the woods in record time, panting, trying not to look back. *He'll be fine,* she assures herself. The claw marks didn't look infected. She set him free; that was enough, wasn't it? She pushes down a pang of guilt, and resolves to redesign her trapping system.

But by the time her feet find the well-worn path to her woodside cabin, she is beginning to feel rather embarrassed. What has

happened to her professional pride? Since when is she even *fazed* by dangerous wildlife? Just this morning she faced down a deadly viperwasp without breaking a sweat - and that territorial creature is far more vicious than any spacebat, mutated or no.

What has gotten *into* her? Surely she wouldn't lose her nerve just because this one was so huge, so clearly intelligent… or from the way he lifted her so easily… or the feeling of his warm breath on her throat… or the way the dappled sunlight rimmed his face, and cast a warm glow through his mantled wings…

Her thoughts are interrupted by a sharp, angry chittering. The noise is all too familiar, after her encounter with the viperwasp earlier that day.

Her stomach drops as she looks down the path. Yes; there it is - likely the same one she'd landed a spell-pouch on this morning. The wolf-sized arachnid splays its chitinous legs across the path, scythelike tail lifted in threat, blocking her way to the cabin. The repellent spell has worn off - and, apparently, resulted in a very *angry* viperwasp. Angry enough to follow her scent… and bring reinforcements.

"Fuck," she whispers, fumbling in her knapsack for her sole remaining repellent pouch - as two *more* viperwasps step out from the brush to either side. Could she try to hit two at once with the spell…? Maybe, but certainly not all three. The safety of her cabin taunts her, just a stone's throw away. She has plenty more spells at the ready there… but the three venomous arachnids clearly do not plan to let her reach them. Already, the first one is advancing, tail held high and beginning to glow a deep red.

Gritting her teeth, she lets fly the packet at the one in the center. As it hits the chitinous armor, it splits open, releasing a plume of sparkling dust - there is an ungodly *screech* - she holds her breath, praying that there might be enough spread to reach all three - the advancing viperwasp shudders, and screeches again, louder, *angrier* - and takes another step forward. Towards her.

"That shady Mystacor *bastard* -!" she hisses under her breath. The spellcaster had *assured* her that each packet was at full potency. Why, *why* in the Nine Hells - why did it have to be her *last* one that was dun?! "I swear to the gods, if these things kill me I'm going to come back and *haunt* him..."

As the chittering arachnid advances, she takes a step backward. "Look - if this is about stepping too close to your nest, I *said* I was sorry…" she pleads, stalling for time. Maybe, just maybe, if she can flee fast enough in the other direction -

From behind her comes a deep, unfamiliar growl.

"...Seriously?" she groans to herself. The growl's resonance rumbles through her like that of a great jungle cat. Clearly, she decides with a sigh, the fates are just taking the piss at this point. That spellcaster had better get ready for a lot of mysterious plate-rattling in his future. Just as she glances back to see what new beast has volunteered to finish her off, the advancing viperwasp *leaps* -

- And slams midair into a snarling slate-blue blur.

<<A/N: Skip to next bolded line to bypass graphic violence/gore.>>

The arachnid gives a shrill screech, thrown backward by a flying mass of muscle, wings, and claws. They hit the ground in a rolling tangle as she stands rooted in place just paces away, staring, caught between terror and utter dumbfounded shock. Amid the violent scuffling, there is another deep snarl - then a loud, sickeningly wet *crunch* - and the screech abruptly cuts off.

The feral spacebat lifts his head from the twitching pile of limbs as the other two viperwasps advance. He throws them a dangerous growl, a full set of vicious fangs on display - their phosphorescent green glowing through a dripping mess of thick, dark fluid. But the threat is not enough to deter his opponents, given their two-on-one advantage. Among her profession, there is a running joke

that viperwasps wake up and choose violence each day; the species is not known for turning down a fight.

That fight lasts all of ten seconds. As one darts forward with its scythe-like stinger, the spacebat snatches the tail just behind its glowing point - and yanks the huge arthropod off its skittering legs. A moment later, it slams bodily into its advancing neighbor with a *crack* of carapace. Both fall limp, the improvised flail twitching dazedly as massive talons jam between plates of carapace and *rip* -

She turns away just in time to avoid the unpleasant visuals. Professional pride be damned; even at her most scientifically curious, she has no desire for a closeup view of dismemberment. The sounds are quite enough already; she winces as another ripping noise, and a wet *crunch,* signify that the third viperwasp has met its end.

She expects there to be quiet, after that - but instead, there is a crackling *pop,* followed by further wet crunching. Curiosity overtakes her squeamishness, and she slowly peeks around through her fingers. Her rescuer has wrenched off a segmented leg from one opponent, and split open its length like a crab's; she stares in horrified fascination as he digs in, face-deep, slurping with obvious enjoyment. He is not a fastidious eater.

For a moment, all is quiet, save for the enthusiastic munching of a clearly pleased spacebat.

<<A/N: Skip to this line; graphic part ends.>>

A wrenched laugh burbles up from her chest as dazed relief mingles with no small amount of horror. It emerges from her throat at a distinctly nervous pitch. "Th-thank... you...?" she manages to croak out. She is still not sure if he saved her deliberately - or if the arthropods are simply the appetizer to his dinner.

The feral one looks up, still munching - swallows - and *grins,* a rather terrifying sight. He holds his grisly snack out towards her in offering.

"Guud," he says cheerfully.

Chapter End Notes

Chapter summary:

The wildlife researcher flees as soon as the spacebat sets her down. He watches, but does not follow. By the time she nears the edge of the Whispering Woods, she has calmed somewhat, and is starting to feel more curiosity than fear. Before she can make it to her cabin, though, she is ambushed by three deadly viperwasps - venomous, dog-sized arthropods known to Choose Violence.

Her sole remaining repellent spell fails to disperse them. Just when her demise seems inevitable, the feral spacebat leaps out from behind her to attack them. He dispatches all three viperwasps easily, and then chows down with messy gusto - while cheerfully offering her some. Such a polite boi. :>

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Some time later, a pile of empty carapace lies discarded in the underbrush - and a very sated, rather pleased-looking spacebat is following her home.

She can't help but admire the grace of his long, loping stride beside her. He moves with a catlike smoothness, with just one exception: even with the extra height of digittigrade feet, the tips of his massive wings trail on the ground behind him when folded. He shifts them frequently, sometimes lifting them up from his body, sometimes wrapping them forward around his shoulders. The latter position gives the impression that he is wearing a long, leathery cloak - a look she finds herself mildly grateful for, as it is just now occurring to her how very *naked* he is.

It is odd, to be unable to settle on how she should think of him. Is this a sentient being, like his wingless brethren who think and speak? Or is he a wild beast, imitating sounds without understanding them as words? With the impromptu "cloak", he does appear somewhat more civilized; but then, it helps that the lower half of his face is no longer dripping with viperwasp goo. Spacebats, she learned, have *surprisingly* long tongues.

…Best not to think about that.

Still, she does not object to him following her. It seems clear enough, at this point, that he means her no harm; and she feels a certain obligation at this point to patch him up, given the fresh new set of scratches from the scuffle. They trickle lurid green over the older cuts from his attempts to escape her own trap. Though he shows little sign of discomfort, she winces with guilt. His slate skin would be smooth and unharmed, had she not set that "harmless" trap yesterday.

… Although, for that matter, *she* would be quite dead.

They reach her woods-edge cabin shortly. At the small building's entrance, both pause at the obvious and unforeseen problem: he stands at least a foot higher than the doorframe. His wings are wrapped around him in the cloak position, but were he to fold them upright, they would stretch two feet higher still. He will have to crouch just to enter her cozy one-room home.

She gives him an apologetic look as she opens the door and gestures for him to follow her inside. He bends, warbling in mild complaint as he scrunches his broad shoulders to fit through the doorframe. The wings he tucks behind him as he leans forward; then, at last, he is through, and can stand upright -

Thunk.

She jumps at his yelp of surprise, nearly yelping herself as well. Are her ceiling beams really that low? They are a foot higher than the door - but - well - at least the ceiling itself follows the A-frame of the roof. He can stand… between the beams. And not move.

"I - I'm so sorry," she mumbles, blushing. "...Maybe you'd better just lie down."

At least he should fit *lengthwise.* Barely.

…Best not to think much on *that* either.

Soon enough, thanks to some explanatory gesturing, the winged spacebat is stretched out on the rug in front of the now-crackling fireplace - and looking quite comfortable. Almost… woozy, in fact. He lounges on his side and watches her with glazed eyes, tail swishing lazily, as she pulls out a med kit from the cupboard and lays out supplies. She eyes his unfocused expression with concern. He *definitely* didn't hit his head *that* hard. Is something else wrong?

Then, as he lowers his head to rest on his arm, she finally notices the slight reddish glow around a scratch down the side of his

neck. Her heart sinks. "Oh, *no…"*

It seems one of the viperwasps *did* manage to sting him after all… and to her knowledge, without immediate treatment, that venom spells certain death.

"Oh no, oh no… why didn't you *tell* me…" she whispers, kneeling at his shoulder. The words feel stupid, even as she says them. He blinks up at her in confusion. How could he have told her? Likely, he does not even know that the venom is deadly to Etherians; to him it must seem like a minor scratch. Her throat tightens as she fights back the twinge of oncoming tears. What would she have done, anyway? Sucked out the poison with her *mouth* on his *neck?* Best not to think on that.

"Ea… sy…?" he murmurs, looking up at her with half-lidded eyes.

She swallows, pushing down her dismay and forcing a smile. "Y-yes. It's all right. I'll take care of you."

The least she can do for him is keep him comfortable, these last few minutes, and not give him reason to be afraid. Biting her lip, she rests one hand on his cheek as the other dabs at the slash with a wet cloth. At least he seems peaceful. Given the lack of reaction to her cleaning his wounds, she assumes it will not be long before the venom stops his breathing… then his heart. Hearts? She has heard something about this species having multiple. No matter. His species are not even from this *planet;* she has precious little knowledge of their biology.

A strange, soft rumbling begins in his chest as she cleans the cuts. Oh, gods... he must be struggling to breathe. She squeezes her eyes shut, and holds back a sniffle. His cheek still feels so warm against her hand; he tilts his head into her touch, that rumbling sound growing stronger, almost like…

…Purring.

She blinks her eyes open as he nuzzles into her hand. A woozy smile has spread over his face; he looks up at her with those

glazed, half-lidded eyes. "Guuuud," he warbles happily, voice slightly distorted through the rumbling purr.

Two things occur to her then. First, the obvious realization that a body four times her mass would have a much different reaction to toxins; and second, a vague recollection of hearing what deadly poisons Etherian spacebats consume *recreationally.*

"You…!" Her mouth drops open. "Gods above! You're not dying - you're just *high!"*

"Hiiiii," he agrees, his smile spreading into a broad grin.

A flood of giddy relief has her returning that grin - and allowing herself to pause cleaning the cuts, to indulge in some less necessary touch. Just... just to celebrate the good news. That's all. The steady purr is joined by pleased little trills as she strokes over his cheekbones, the sides of his neck, his full chest... enjoying the smooth springiness of the skin and muscle beneath her fingers... hmm. Best not to think about how lovely that feels. After one more furtive squeeze, she returns to her task.

Viperwasp venom appears to be an excellent numbing agent; if anything, he seems to be rather enjoying her attentions, chirruping and wriggling slightly beneath her touch. With the dried streaks of phosphorescent green daubed from his skin, the damage beneath looks far less dire; most have stopped bleeding, and the ones from his own claws seem to be healing well already. The relaxed purring continues, even as she carefully wraps a bandage around a deeper forearm slash. When something soft brushes her back, she startles alert - only to find his plumed tail curling lazily around her body, in playful imitation of her efforts. He warbles and hums, looking rather proud of himself, and she can’t help but giggle in response.

The feral one rolls onto his back, arching for a moment to unfold his wings out to either side - a rather pretty pose that emphasizes the impressive musculature of his chest and abdomen. She takes the opportunity to study what appear to be extra muscles along

his ribs, inspecting them under the guise of dabbing his skin with the damp cloth - well, not so much dabbing as *petting,* but she doubts he will know the difference. The layered contours flex beneath her hands as he shifts his wings.

...Wings which, a moment later, are folding around her *entire* body.

She yelps in surprise as he pulls her in, wrapping his wings around her like a trapper's net and pressing her down against him. The powerful arms enfold her as well, one massive hand tucking her head into his rumbling chest; held like this, that purr resonates *through* her.

She is too surprised to struggle; and, after the initial shock wears off, quickly decides she doesn't need to.

There is likely some professional rule, she considers, against *snuggling* with the wildlife. This feral creature is a subject of *scientific study,* not… well… whatever is happening here.

But… at the moment, it is somewhat difficult to think of the winged spacebat as *wildlife.* With his powerful arms pressing her to his warm, firm chest - with her face tucked against the crook of his neck, blinding her to his more alien features - he feels like - well, like… a man. A very… large, broad, muscular man… with warm, smooth skin… who smells like… supple leather, and sugarcane, and forest musk…

She is racking up quite the list of things it is best not to think about.

Chapter End Notes

"Best not to think on that" is the new "that's what she said". :P
More fluff to follow. Eventually I'll get to the smut, but I'm having too much fun xD

Chapter 4

Any wildlife researcher like her would *kill* for an opportunity like this - to observe and study an entirely new species up close. For that is what she is doing, she reasons, as she strokes the purring spacebat's ear.

He chirrups gently, tilting his head in her lap, and the outstretched wing shifts position. "No, no. Put that back," she chides, setting the pencil in her other hand down on her sketchbook - which is spread out over the back of his broad shoulder. She leans over to reposition the wing by its muscled upper "arm".

"Put same," he murmurs placidly. "More make pet."

She stifles a laugh, and returns to petting his ear. Over the last few hours, he has picked up speech at an admirable rate. The Whispering Woods are known to have a strange effect on their occupants; could he have known words before, and simply forgotten them? Notes are scribbled in her sketchbook, along with a rendering of one wing and its connected muscles. She strokes the wing's leading edge idly with her hand, tracing the contours with her fingertips to ensure she has not missed any anatomical feature. Yes. That is the reason. For science.

His purring swells, and he shifts again, this time arching his entire body to angle his wing into her touch. Her sketchbook tumbles to the floor. "Oh, for… where's another viperwasp when you need one?" she grumbles. Clearly, the rest of the drawing will have to wait; the venom has worn off, and her subject of study is far too awake to sit still and be posed. Or used as a desk.

His alertness presses a new conundrum as well, one she has been trying to avoid thinking about. So far, she has managed to keep thinking of him as particularly intelligent wildlife - and therefore ignore his nudity. Of course, there is not much to see at the *moment,* given the slit-sheath model of anatomy he shares with his wingless cousins. She has carefully avoided that area, for fear

of something… unprofessional… happening. Really, she has no idea what might happen - and given his massive size and many sharp features, she is rather afraid to find out. Are there others of his species, or… is she…? Best not to think about that.

Still… the more clear intelligence he shows, the more vaguely awkward she feels, petting and cooing to what might as well be a very large and very *naked* man in her cozy cabin. As he grins up at her, the brightness in his eyes now ranks almost equal a concern to those alarmingly oversized fangs. His ears flutter playfully - and she realizes, all of a sudden, that this prickling in her cheeks is a *blush.* Oh, gods. Not good.

"All right, that's it -" she mutters to herself in annoyance, and extricates her lap from beneath his head. When he warbles in complaint, craning after her, she sighs. "I, uh… I'm gonna go grab you some skirts."

She ducks into a closet, and emerges a moment later with a broad tablecloth - hopefully large enough for his frame. She blushes as he tilts his head in confusion. "It's, uh, for… for the naked. Could you stand up for a minute? - *Wait, watch your head!"*

Thunk. The warning comes too late; she winces in sympathy as her large friend once again greets a ceiling beam with his skull. "Sorry about those…" she sighs, as he warbles and shakes his head. "Just… just hold still, okay…?"

He stands as directed, looking down at her quizzically as she holds the cloth up to his waist to gauge the fit. The tail and digittigrade legs make trousers impossible - not that she has any remotely large enough. Standing up close to him like this, her face barely comes level with his groin.

…Best not to think about that.

After a moment of consideration, she wraps one edge of the cloth around his waist, and ties the two upper corners together in an improvised sarong. It takes a few moments of fiddling to

determine the right angle, finally placing the "slit" over one hip. It leaves that leg free, but the feral spacebat warbles and shifts his other leg, clearly feeling constrained. "No guud," he mutters, tail swishing beneath the skirt. He then pulls the front of the cloth aside and tucks it in at the waist, freeing his legs - and completely exposing himself. "Guud!" he chirps with a grin.

She groans, and drops her face into her hands to avoid staring directly between his legs. "That's… not… you're kinda missing the point," she stutters, and sighs. "Look, I know you don't understand… well, you're *naked."*

"Nay… ked," he considers, tilting his head eye level with the ceiling beams. He looks down at her, ears lowered. "...Bad?"

At his crestfallen expression, she finds herself backpedaling to reassure him. She waves her hands in dissent. "N-no! No no, you're not *bad.* You're *very* good. Just... naked is for family, or…" She fumbles for words he might understand. "Ones who are... very close. Like. Uh."

She trails off as the winged beast lowers gracefully to a crouch, bringing his face to her eye level. His tail snakes around from behind, catching her by the waist, drawing her forward; as it does, he lifts a huge hand, and rests his palm over her cheek. With utmost gentleness his fingers curve around her head, holding her in place, as his face comes close... *very* close.

"Close. Yes?" he says, with a gleaming smile.

"Th-that's... not quite what I…" she whispers.

There is no stopping that blush now, no matter how hard she tries.

The spacebat tilts his head, brow-ridge furrowed in a curious expression. He thrums softly as he looks her over - seeming for all the world to inspect her as she had done him - then smiles brightly, as if the world suddenly makes sense. “Put same,” he says with confidence. “Make pet.”

"...Huh…?"

He unwinds his tail from around her, and turns to gesture at the cabin's front door with his head. Confused, she opens it for him, watches as he squeezes his way through and out into the warm summer night, then gestures for her to follow. She does so with caution - and does not take more than a few steps from the door. It is never a good idea to venture out into the Whispering Woods after sunset.

With apparent relief, the feral one stands upright and stretches his wings to their full *enormous* span. For a moment, she simply stares in admiration at the dramatic sight of his moonlit silhouette. That calm breaks once he folds his wings to his sides and takes a loping step towards the edge of the woods, then turns back with a smile - and loops his tail once more around her waist.

"Come. Put same."

She edges back, eyeing the darkness of the woods. "Follow you…? I - ohh, no, I'm sorry, not - not right now. It's not safe at night. For me, I mean."

With a low thrum, he bends down, and pulls her close to his body with one thick-muscled arm. She flushes again as she feels him nuzzle her hair with his cheek, then - is that his ear, brushing against her?

A moment later, that flush deepens to a burn, as his breath warms her ear.

"Safe," he murmurs, with a tone of absolute certainty. "I… *make* safe. For you."

Without another word, his arms sweep beneath her, and lift her bodily from her feet - as easily as one might lift a cat, and with about as much cooperation from the passenger. She yelps and flails as the ground disappears. In a moment, though, one solid surface is replaced with another - the warm, broad swell of his

chest. He folds her securely into his arms, thrumming softly. “Easy. Eeeasy. Safe.”

The reassuring tone of the words is undermined, as she feels his weight shift against her. Oh gods. Oh *gods.* “Nonono *wait* -” she gasps; but her words are obscured by the powerful *snap* of his massive wings, cast open into the night sky.

A moment later, the world falls away.

Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The Whispering Woods stretch for acres in either direction, a deep tangle of magic-soaked wilds. The forest canopy is as alive at night as it is at noon; glowing insects and small birds streak through the moonlit treetops, ducking into the shadows of gnarled branches. Some of them never emerge. For just a moment, one might see the many-eyed shadows responsible - before those, too, slink away under cover of darkness. The summer songs of night, trilling chirps and clicks, continue unbroken; and the silver glow of a cloudless moon paints deceptive assurance of calm.

She perceives none of this quiet, eerily beautiful landscape. She is too busy screaming.

The spacebat holds her face tucked into his powerful chest, muffling her high-pitched terror. His hold is entirely secure; she is likely safer in his arms, high in the air, than she would be crossing the forest floor. She does not *care.* Her kind is *not* meant to fly. It is neither right nor proper. She wants to be back on solid ground *right now,* and she tells him so, at the top of her lungs. Thankfully, he does not oblige, for doing so would result in her plummeting to the trees - and if the fall did not kill her, those many-eyed shadows would be happy to finish the job.

Each heavy beat of his wings throws the two of them violently upwards, higher and higher into the open sky, until the forest spreads in a dark blanket beneath them. She empties her lungs for the second time just as their height begins to level off, and draws another frenzied gasp. The powerful wingbeats slow, their flight path now a smoother glide. She continues screaming just a bit longer for good measure, and for the sake of principle.

At the end of the third lungful, upon realizing she is still alive, she finally trails off. The spacebat makes a wordless, pained whine above her head as her shrieks fade into ragged gasps.

"Loud," he huffs. "Small you. *Big* loud."

Wind catches her hair as it rushes past them. To either side, the great wings shift, catching the air with a soft fluttering sound at the leading edge before casting down with a *whoomf* . She dares a terrified peek out from the blind safety of his chest, only to whimper and bury her face again when the world *tilts* and spins around one lowered wingtip.

Luckily, the rest of the flight is a smooth glide. In a few minutes they are banking along the face of a sheer cliff that overlooks the forest; she even manages to peek out again as they pass the soft roar of a waterfall. The broad wings angle back to slow their path, as they approach a broad horizontal slash in the cliff. Before she can catch more than a glimpse, though, the wings beat forward and down, and the resulting lurch has her hiding her face once again.

The landing is not particularly gentle. He does at least take care to maintain his grip, as they drop the last few yards in a half-glide, half-freefall. The wrench of sudden gravity defies her lungs from a scream this time as her transport lands in a crouch, giving one last pump of his wings to stabilize his footing.

At last, then, all is… *blessedly* still.

She clings to him, trembling, not sure if she is ready to believe in the mercy of solid ground. He moves to put her down, lowering his arms, but she will have none of it; she has survived this long by clutching him, and is loath to trust any other method. After a moment he seems to shrug, and abandons the effort. Instead, he settles - still with his quivering armload - down into something unexpectedly soft.

The curled tendril of a fern brushes her face as he shifts onto his side. The shelter of his arms surrounds her, secure; so at last she dares lift her head, to look around the cliffside aerie that is clearly his home.

The ledge is not quite a cave, but deep enough to shelter from wind and rain. Some hardy scrub has managed to root into the rock, providing scattered anchors for a thick bed of mosses and other soft greenery - clearly gathered from the woods below, like a huge nest. They are situated, in her eyes, *unnervingly* close to the edge of the rocky platform. At the very lip, a few discarded pieces of empty viperwasp carapace form a spiky pile. As she blinks at the sight, she feels him shift, kicking out his leg - sending the scraps clattering off the side of the ledge.

He huffs above her; when she looks up, he lowers his ears and gives a crooked smile that looks almost chagrined. There is a tiny splash as the shells land in the river, far below, almost out of earshot. She decides not to think about *how* far below, for now; he is stroking the top of her head, thrumming softly, and that is a far more pleasant focus for her attention.

She feels him nuzzle her head, then - is he *licking* her *hair?* She shifts and looks up in confusion. "Put same," he explains, and tilts his head to the side - showing her the cut on his neck, now looking far less angry-red after her attentions. "You make."

To clarify the statement, he nuzzles at the side of her head, down past her ear - and gently presses her head to the side. She flinches reflexively, a hand coming up to cover the side of her neck, and he gives a soft huff. "No bite," he sighs in a reluctant tone, before nuzzling at her hand.

She inhales as understanding sets in. *Put same.* She brought him to her home, and 'groomed' him by cleaning his wounds; now, he is returning the favor.

A chance to study the private grooming rituals of a brand-new species… why, it would be *ludicrous* to decline. She pulls her lip

between her teeth, gives a slow exhale, and allows him to nudge her hand aside.

Despite being *entirely* forewarned, she still gasps as his tongue finds her throat.

The wet heat sends an immediate prickling flush up her cheeks, and she clamps her mouth closed to avoid making any noise. This is… just grooming. Just… friendly mutual grooming. Communal species perform such rituals every day, and now she has a chance to observe it up close and personal. *Very* personal. He shifts her in his arms, arranging her on the greenery beside him - and she stifles a whimper as one enormous hand tilts her head to further expose her throat to his mouth.

Oh… oh gods. This… should *not* feel as good as it does.

His tongue moves down over her throat, 'cleaning' in a meticulous pattern. A growing flush covers her face despite her best efforts. Indeed, her skin heats warmer and warmer the more she tries *not* to think about anything… unprofessional. She is a *scientist,* she reminds herself, steadying her breathing. This creature is *not* a man - no matter how much he feels like one - especially *holding* her like this, *petting* her like this…

She swallows, and bites down on her lip, as the *research subject* nudges under her sleeveless top. It is a warm night… and seems to have grown *much* warmer, despite the altitude and open air. Perhaps it is the heat radiating from his body, pressed up beside her in his 'nest'. She can feel the low rumble begin against her as he starts purring deep in his chest, soft, reassuring. His huge claws have caught the hem of her top in his pawing, and he flattens his tongue along her collarbone as his hand strokes so firmly up her waist, baring her skin… *not* a man, she reminds herself, breath catching beneath his hands. He does not *know* what this feels like to her kind - his species does not see nudity as the *least* bit sexual - he is returning a perceived favor, and that is *all.*

She whimpers, but does not stop him, as he pushes her shirt up over her breastband - and sets off down her body with his mouth.

Chapter End Notes

FINALLY GOT TO THE SMUT

Chapter 6

She should put a stop to this, she knows. She really, really should.

The sheer cliffside juts up into the sky behind her; and before her looms the massive, moon-rimmed silhouette. With his head bowed between his shoulders, the only visible features are the soft green glow of his eyes and mouth - but there is a trace of phosphorescence marking the slick paths of his tongue down her body. She is trying very, very hard not to arch up into that tongue.

He shifts above her, so that half-folded wings frame either side of her field of vision. Behind their graceful arc, there is nothing but the stars. She should *not* be admiring that silhouette so ardently. She tries to keep her focus on something, *anything* else - on the quiet roar of the waterfall some distance away, on the living songs of the forest spread out far beneath them, on the shining moon hanging in the sky - or, gods, on the *reports* she will have to write about this somehow, carefully scrubbed of detail to avoid scandalizing the entire wildlife research community. She tries to focus on anything that might save her from *moaning* as the winged creature slides his tongue along the inner hollow of her hip.

She tries, and fails.

He shifts at the sound, still purring, and looks up at her with those unreadable glowing eyes. Oh *gods.* A surge of embarrassment floods through her, powerful enough to at last overcome that mad, shameful part of her that didn't stop this *immediately.* "O-okay that's - that's enough -" she blurts, hoping the violent flush in her cheeks is less visible in moonlight.

The purring quiets. "Bad?" he murmurs.

“N-no! Not - not *bad,* it’s… you’re *very* good. I-I mean - oh, gods.” She blushes deeper, stumbling over her words and the lingering warmth of his tongue across her skin. She can’t bring herself to tell him she *dislikes* what is happening. Partly because of his sweet purr… but mostly, because she cannot bring herself to outright *lie.*

“I just - it’s not *right* to let you - I shouldn’t -” Blast, how can she put this the right way? She falters again, inhales, and then the words rush out: “Y-you really don’t know what this is *doing* to me.”

“Mmn...?” The spacebat tilts his head, as if in curiosity - but the gesture has a different effect when his face hovers just above her hips. There is something… different about his voice, as that purring resumes in his chest. Lower. Breathier. She swallows, unable to reply; her own voice has stopped working, as her heart thumps into her throat.

His pupilless eyes seem to stare straight into her, as he moves down, ever so slightly, and *...inhales.*

That *look* in those gleaming eyes is… no longer unreadable.

Heart pounding, breath caught in her throat, she can barely manage a whimper as the huge silhouette rises over her. His purring has grown deeper, rougher somehow, sounding almost like a soft growl. He leans forward over her, splaying one broad hand across her ribs, pressing down… holding her body in place, as the other hand hooks its claws into the waistband of her leggings. Even *she* can catch the scent of her own arousal, now - the thin fabric is no cover. She pulls in tight shallow breaths, chest fluttering with the realization of how *blatant* that scent must be to *him.* How blatant it *has* been, from the moment his tongue first touched her burning skin.

His eyes never break their searing gaze as his claws flash... and, in one savage motion, *rip* the leggings from her thighs.

The force of the tear yanks her hips upwards. "Oh *fuck* -!" she gasps - the claws across her ribs dig in, pinning her upper body, as his other hand shreds free of the fabric - and then that hand is beneath her, huge clawed fingers splayed to grip the flesh of her rear, lifting her half-off the ground. She yelps, and her legs kick out in reflexive panic - but in the next moment he has both those enormous hands around her thighs from beneath - and pulls her hips up towards him with a full-throated *growl.*

That veneer of gentleness has evaporated into the night. She clutches at the soft greenery beneath her, heart pounding, exposed skin burning beneath the creature's warm breath. Her legs tremble violently as she tries by instinct to hold them closed. The effort has no effect; his grip forces her thighs apart as easily as one pulling unruly ferns. Something inside her clenches *hard.*

Without further warning, his face dives in to devour her.

His mouth *attacks* her flushed, dripping sex, with such ferocity that she cries out - convinced he might *literally* eat her. That cry quickly morphs, as shock and fear give way to ecstasy. His tongue seems to be everywhere at once - his growl rumbles into her core - deep - *ravenous* - he hauls up on her hips, rearing back, lifting her entire body off the ground - she throws her head back into empty air and *wails,* in equal parts terror and bliss.

The darkly beautiful landscape of the Whispering Wood stretches out beneath - or rather *above* her. She dangles upside down from the feral one’s grip, legs clamped around his muscular neck with fervor. Sharp claws are digging into the flesh of her rear - she does not *care* - his impossibly long tongue has pushed its way *inside* her, and is now buried deep, *writhing.* Her helpless gasps and cries echo into the open sky. Gods above, it feels so alien, so ludicrously *wrong* - and so unbelievably *good* -

Her shuddering wail of climax is met with a ravenous groan. He buries himself in the slick mess of her crux, tongue still laving at her inner walls, as if trying to consume her from the inside. Only when her shaking legs go limp around his neck does the

onslaught slow, then finally relent… and the world spins around her.

She lands on her back with a soft *whumpf,* dazed and gasping, blurred vision streaked with stars. Clawed hands land roughly on either side of her shoulders. As her vision clears, the massive, winged silhouette looms above her - breathing heavily, glowing fangs bared wide, eyes *blazing* with savage lust.

Previous worries about scandalizing her colleagues have now given way to a more primal concern: in order to ignite such a scandal, she must *survive* to tell the tale. Would a beast like this even *listen* , if she begged him to stop?

Would she… *want* him to listen?

That question dissolves in her mind, unanswered, as her attention falls on the lumescent shape pulsing above her splayed thighs - slick, hot, and *huge.*

Chapter 7

Chapter Notes

> After much wait (sry writers block eheh), the steamy finale~! Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The feral one's deep growl seems to drip down from above - like that bestial lust is overflowing from his chest, thick and hot and dangerous.

Much the same as the viscous, phosphorescent fluid dripping down from… *that.*

He gives no pause. Even as she reels from the shuddering aftershocks of climax, he pushes her shaking legs further open with single-minded focus. His weight comes down between her hips, grinding - pushing that hot shape against her inner thigh, painting her skin with its slick coating. The drawn-aside skirts tangle and pull between their bodies; with a dismissive snarl, he simply rips them from his hips. Then, the breadth of his body is on her, over her, pressing her down… and that slick, pulsing heat is grinding against her swollen sex.

Gods, his entire body feels so warm, so firm, so huge and *powerful* against her - but this - full and hot and *alive* as it presses against her nether lips - she lets her head fall back with a drawn-out gasp. "F- *fuck…"*

That is all the invitation he needs. She can feel the rumble of his bestial growl through the weight of his body, half-crushing her beneath him. As huge clawed hands pull her hips into position, she finds her hands clutching at his contoured waist; her shaking grip might as well be made of paper, for all he seems to notice. He grinds between her thighs, aligning that slithering heat, and then - as she chokes out a wild cry - *forces* inside.

The savage thrust overwhelms her in a flood of pleasure and pain. She cries out high and sharp, arching up against his weight as he snarls his pleasure above her. Her fingers dig into his sides - but not to push him away - *pulling* him down until his frame engulfs her, her face buried in his full, heavy chest, her gasps silenced by his rumbling growl -

With a harsh groan, he shifts again. His huge frame presses her down - she can barely breathe, but she pulls in a shuddering gasp as she feels the hot girth withdraw - only to plunge deeper, filling her, spreading her wide, and all she can do is *yield.* Her muffled screams die out as her lungs empty and her body gives way, helpless to the powerful rush of heat.

The crushing weight shifts, letting her breathless, choked whimpers drag into a desperate gasp of air. But the movement is not one of mercy; his hips angle deeper, forcing her further open, shoving himself into her depths. Harsh, panting growls overtake her cries as he pumps inside. Through unfocused eyes she sees him drop his head between his arms, back bowed, panting roughly - and then his mouth is at her throat - his tongue dragging over her skin - leaving ravenous streaks of wild, wet heat.

She can feel the oversized fangs graze against her with each rhythmic thrust, offset by his swirling tongue - the slick pleasure mingling with that mounting force, merging, amplifying into something greater - and so too for his thick, searing shaft ramming inside her again and again -

Her face is buried in the crook of his shoulder as she gasps and moans. His skin tastes of sugar, and sweat, and suede. She grips him, clenches down on the undulating cords of hard muscle with her thighs, her sex, her hands, her *teeth* -

And against her throat, he groans - *"Yyyessss -"*

- And his jaw closes down around her slender throat.

Powerful hands grip her by the back of the head and waist, clutching her close - and baring the side of her neck. She gives a ragged, breathless cry as the points of pressure sink into *pain* - and yet that, too, only merges with the surging ecstasy pumping through her core, drawing a conduit up through her entire body as the pain blooms and flares and *crashes* through her as something *else entirely* -

Her cries melt into a long, high wail of release. Just before her eyes roll back, she sees the great wings stretched out into the sky above them, spread wide in triumph.

The signal of a mantled predator is familiar to her - a victory, and a warning to any foolish enough to approach. Stay back; here, a monster is taking his meal.

Or, tonight, his mate.

Some deep, primal, irrational part of her *thrills* at the thought. *Fuck* the research, it crows. *Fuck* the peer reviews - the only eyes that matter are those of the Whispering Woods. Let the wilds see this victory; let her cries of blissful surrender echo across the night sky. Let the stalking, shadowy threats of these woods find her already claimed - by the most dangerous of them all.

The sweet musk of his skin is intoxicating - but even more so, the *power* in his massive frame. His pace slows to let her shudder through the aftershocks of climax, but even now, new sparks of thrill ignite - as he grabs her clutching hands and forces them down. She struggles against him almost automatically, but not to resist. Even yanking at her arms with all her strength has no effect, she knows - and yet - somehow, she finds herself *reveling* in the raw exertion - and the unyielding strength of his body's reply.

Huge hands engulf her wrists, pinning them beside her shoulders. Then - oh, gods, then his hips are moving again - that hot, thick shape pushing back inside. "Fuck -!" she gasps, before her voice fails beneath his jaws - his rhythm picks up - with each rough

stroke, her entire form rocks back - and he growls into her throat, fangs still anchored in place, and bites down *hard.*

Her weak, helpless cries choke off as he thrusts up inside. She can barely breathe - and she does not *care.* She wants nothing but this - *him* - taking her, devouring her - Gods, yes, she wants him to mark her as *his* - with his scent - and his sweat - and his *teeth* - and his *come.*

She moans raggedly and arches up as his tongue swirls amidst the blooming pain of his fangs. A moment later, that moan becomes a raw yell - as his hips *slam* down.

Stars explode across her vision. The force of his thrust drives him in to the hilt - ramming the thickened swell of his base past her taut entrance. A scream chokes off in her throat, the tiny sound lost against his guttural groan.

Her entire body shudders deeply, powerless, as she gives in to his swell. He pulls free from her throat with a gasp, and braces up on his forearms to grind his lower body down against her. Ragged, panting growls heave above her as he crushes her with the force of his pressing hips - his grip on her wrists bears down, muscles standing taut all up his braced arms and shoulders and neck - as he shudders into her, and throws back his head to the sky. She *feels* his release as he surges inside her with a savage, thunderous *roar.*

Her own body succumbs with his, overwhelmed - spasming helplessly as his huge shaft pulses inside - pumping, flooding her with heat. If she screams, she does not hear it, for his bestial roar floods her as well. The stars above are blinding surges of light, filling the sky - filling *her.* Her senses crumble.

In her world, there is nothing more to perceive - nothing but the glorious span of outstretched wings.

She is not sure how many moments pass, before she can feel her body again. Her breathing is the first to register in her conscious:

deep, ragged gasps. Then, the weight and heat of the feral creature, still on top of her, but now wrapped around her body with possessive firmness. His arms clutch her to his chest - sweat-sheened, radiating heat, shuddering with heavy breaths.

Then, the rest of her body registers once more - the strained, throbbing fullness inside her - so full it *aches.*

As she moans and shifts beneath him, she feels his huge shaft twitch in response. His breathy groan joins her gasp. Arms tighten around her, stilling her. The swell of his base is still lodged inside - too tight to escape her stretched entrance.

"S-stay…" groans his voice from above her head.

Her conscious mind has trickled back just enough to recognize this particular anatomical feature. Patience will unbind them eventually; whereas impatience… will *hurt.* She forces herself still, trying to steady her breathing, and he rewards her courage with a gentle purr.

Soon, as the purring swells through her, she no longer has to force herself to settle in his arms. His huge hand strokes softly over her hair, as the great wings tuck in around them both.

The heat of his mouth at her throat makes her whimper - at first, in confusion - then, as his tongue slides over the bite wounds, *pain.* She whines as the sting pushes through her ebbing adrenaline and arousal. It takes another moment to recognize the trickling sensation down her neck, and the scent of her own blood… by which time the feral one has cleaned most of it away, giving low ardent thrums of enjoyment. She shivers beneath his mouth, caught between a spike of horror at how he *savors* the taste - and the wash of pleasure at the swirling of his tongue.

It does feel… *very* nice.

Her research mind stirs at the warm spreading tingle, considering possibilities of natural healing compounds in saliva… and

wondering how in the nine hells she will explain how she *discovered* such qualities.

But… reports can wait, she decides. She leans into his attentions with a sigh of pleasure. The swell inside her is waning somewhat, now a comfortable pulsing fullness; but he makes no move to withdraw himself, and… neither does she. It is… so warm here, beneath his weight. Her legs curl loosely around his hips, but the rest of her is fully enclosed within the cocoon of his arms and wings. She can stay, and soak in more of his sweet scent.

Yes… she will see if the viperwasps are still so aggressive once she smells like seven feet of muscle and claws. And if they are, well… apparently viperwasp venom is this one's favorite treat.

…Aside from her throat.

Her new companion nuzzles at the cleaned mark… and, ever so gently, grazes his fangs further up the side of her neck to her ear. She shivers and whimpers as his warm, soft breath contrasts the points.

"Yes bite…" he purrs in her ear, with a satisfied air.

"Y-yes…" she moans, and tilts her head… stretching out the opposite side of her neck.

"...Put… same."

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you enjoyed! As always, if you want moar shameless spacebat smut, friend req LadyBinary#8135 on Discord for an 18+ server of Prime simps and bat-tiddy faceplants. <3

Chapter 8

Chapter Notes

> Surprise! Bonus fluffy-steamy epilogue chapter! I went back to read through the fic and realized the pacing could use a nice denouement. And who could say no to more bat snuggles? Certainly not me... nor our intrepid Etherian wildlife researcher.

The mutated specimen's saliva appears to have healing properties similar to a common first-aid spell packet: bleeding cessation, pain relief, and accelerated healing of minor surface cuts and bruises...

After chewing on her pencil, she crosses out "pain relief". After all, she is describing these qualities as if she has *observed* them... not *experienced* them.

The specimen in question shifts his hip beneath her arm, unbalancing the notebook; she manages to catch it before it falls. The crackling sounds of the fireplace, and the soft patter of rainfall on the roof above, are no match for his purring. That deep rumble fills the small cabin, as if she has placed an outboard motor in the middle of her living room - which, for that matter, would provide a similar output of warmth.

"Ree-sur-chay-pur," he warbles from behind. His chest makes an excellent backrest. With that purr, and his plumed tail curling lazily on the rug, she might have imagined she is leaning against some great domesticated cat… except that *he* is the one petting *her.* His arm is draped around her waist from behind, the great clawed hand idly stroking over her hip.

"That's right. Research paper," she replies, grinning. "But if you don't hold still, I'm going to have to move to an actual desk."

"Nooooo." The sound is a distorted whine. She hears the leathery wings shift over the rug; the feral one curls closer around her, that

corded forearm pulling her back against his chest. He peers around from behind her shoulder, all low ears and huge, pleading eyes... atop several hundred pounds of deadly muscle and claws. "Stay," he implores. "Holllh… hold."

How can she say no to that sweet face? Regardless of the fact that, even if she *wanted* to get up… the heavy arm may as well be a steel girder across her lap.

"Fiiine…" she sighs in mock reluctance. Her broad smile as she wriggles back into his hold betrays the truth. "But you're *not* going to distract me from this paper."

"Be guud," he agrees, and nuzzles into her neck from behind.

The soft purring swells again; all other sounds seem to fade into the background, the rain and the chirping night creatures of the outside world forgotten. She feels the full, firm muscles shift against her back, as his chest rises and falls with his breathing. Only the occasional gentle pop from the fireplace breaks through the thrum. With a sigh of enjoyment, she returns to her task.

The specimen shows high intelligence, self-awareness, and adaptability. Though found alone, our subject responds well to Etherian contact, picking up impressive communication strategies and rudimentary language.

Adaptation to greater society seems unlikely, given the refusal to engage with social mores such as clothing. This lack of interest should not be confused with lack of intelligence…

His hand spreads over her naked hip, gently squeezing her close. She hums with his purr; the rumbling warmth sinks in through her bare spine. The trappings and drapings of society are clearly overrated.

A moment later, her lettering veers off on a wild streak across the page. A factor in this misfortune, perhaps, is her own recent rejection of society's drapings - for his hot tongue has just slid up the back of her exposed neck.

He shifts behind her, sitting up on his hip to trail a teasing set of claws up the front of her body. His tail swishes playfully across the rug. "Ree-such," he purrs in her ear. "I… halp."

"This… *isn't* helping the paper…" she attempts, weakly. Her voice comes out as little more than a whimper as his tongue continues to paint her neck. The smooth backs of his talons glide over her breasts, and a shivering little moan escapes her. Perhaps she should include a note about the specimen's high *libido…*

…But then again, she can hardly comment on that, given what has happened to *hers.*

When the weight of his jaws closes around her neck from behind, she moans outright. Gods, at this point, the response is all but Pavlovian. The pressure of his fangs on her throat, not quite breaking the skin, sends her heart racing… and *not* from fear.

A flare of heat blooms between her hips as that pressure increases. Playfully, he chews on her throat, bathing her skin with his tongue, and she gives an open moan. The previous wounds have healed over impossibly fast, with nary a scar; they should be painful, and yet… the skin beneath his tongue tingles, richly sensitive, thirsting for more.

That tenderness is oddly, deliciously similar to the lingering ache in her sex. The ache of having *fully* accepted him. She squeezes her thighs together as another flare of heat accompanies the thought… and he growls low into her throat from behind. With that sound, all resistance is utterly undone.

The notebook and pencil slide down to the rug, abandoned. “Ah, hells…” she sighs under her breath. “You’ve *trained* me…”

At her throat, his deep growl morphs into a chuckle. “Mmn hnn…”

Tugging gently on her neck with his fangs, he settles back onto the rug, and pulls her with him - letting her naked form arch over his body, quivering beneath his stroking talons. The great wings come up around her from either side to capture her, and she

makes no attempt to struggle. Her head tilts back as she melts into his touch.

There will be no further writing done tonight. She has… additional research to do. Yes. That's it. For science.

...She really does need to figure out why the fangs sinking into her throat feel… so damned *good.*

"Y-yes… bite…" she moans, voice hitching as her tameless lover obeys. "H… *harder."*

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